



UQFC - U9-13 - Defensive Block - Session 2

Category: Academy: Low-block and press

Difficulty: Moderate

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Description

Main Principle: Defensive Block

Behaviour: Compact defensive and wait to steal the ball

Why? To outnumber the opposition and prevent goal scoring opportunities to steal the ball back.

Rondo (20 mins)

Positioning Games 6v3 (7-a-side) 4v2 (two games running for 9-a-side) (If less than 10 players do 6v3)

Area - 20 yards long and 20 yards wide (two setups)

Time - 3 sets of 4 minutes with a two-minute rest (use for dual force/speed agility - Coaches Choice)

Action - Defending

Behaviour - Compact, wait, steal the ball

Rules:

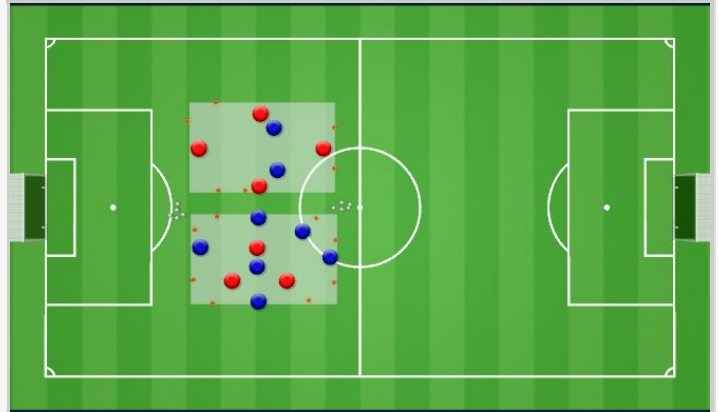
- Six/Four attackers and three/two defenders
- When the defenders win the ball, try and score into one of the goals
- Attackers defend to win back the ball and play
- Rotate out the defenders after one minute
- Reposition the goals each set
- Use pop-up goals, poles or cones, minimum of three goals needed

Coaching:

- Observe the defending action and behaviours (compact, wait, steal the ball)
- Motivate the attackers to defend each goal purposely
- Check for outsiders (players that do not react to defend)

Water Break

Duration 5 minutes



Positional Play (25 mins)

Positional Play - Attack vs Defence

Area - half-size pitch + 10m attack zone

Time - 25 minutes

Action - Defending

Behaviour - Compact, wait, steal the ball

Rules:

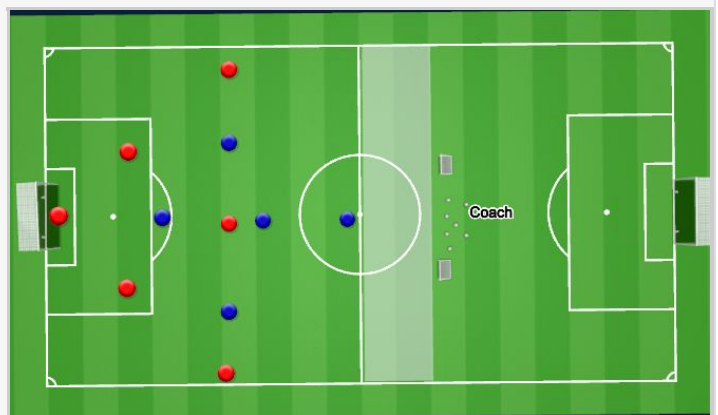
- Red start from the big goal and aim to progress the ballover halfway for 1 point and score in the mini goal for an additional point
- Blue aim to steal the ball and score in the big goal
- Play restarts with Coach playing into Blue - Swap directions after 4 min

Coaching:

- Can we prevent the opposition from playing forwards and playing it somewhere we can win the ball
- Remain compact to prevent forward play to their striker.
- Slide and shift when the ball is played from one side to another
- Prevent the ball carrier from playing forward - people behind the person pressing the ball directing to where we want to win the ball.
- If the ball goes past you, quickly recover and help your team-mates.

Water Break:

Speak to the players during water break and question about when the times we have to recover and compact compared to being brave and risking to win the ball



Game (30 mins)

Medium Game 6v6 (adjust)

Area - as diagram

Time - 3 rounds of 8, 7, and 6 minutes (breaks 2 minutes and 1 minute)

Focus - Defending

Coaching:

- Reinforce the player action to recover behind the ball into the defensive organisation
- Encourage players to get back, be compact and create traps
- Praise team and individual moments when players have displayed great defending (recovered together, patient, stole the ball)

Summary:

Take 3/4 minutes at the end to discuss the session focus with the players

Ask them about the key defensive actions and why these are

